

different concept from existing game devices in order to provide players with a unique entertainment experience for the 21st century."

On 21 November 2004, Nintendo released the device in North America, and has so far sold almost 102 million handsets across the world.

3.2.1 HARDWARE

Design

Unlike the candybar design of the PlayStation Portable, the Nintendo DS featured a clamshell design, with each part of the two halves having a 3-inch TFT-LCD screen (256x192 pixels resolution) in the centre. The name of the system, 'DS', is claimed to derive from this Dual Screen approach.

However, the dual screen was not all that was going into changing the way handheld games were played. The lower display of the Nintendo DS was overlaid with a touchscreen, designed to accept input from the included stylus, the user's fingers, or a curved plastic tab attached to the optional wrist strap.

The touchscreen allows users to interact with in-game elements more directly than by pressing buttons; for example, in the included chatting software, PictoChat, the stylus is used to write messages or draw.

The latest iteration of the console, dubbed the DSi, has two larger TFT-LCD screens at 3.25 inches, capable of displaying 256K colours.

Traditional controls are located on either side of the touchscreen. To the left is a four-way navigational pad, with a narrow Power button above it, and to the right are the A, B, X, and Y buttons, with narrow Select and Start buttons above them. Shoulder buttons L and R are located on the upper corners of the lower half of the system. The overall button layout is similar to the controller of the Super Nintendo Entertainment System.

The Nintendo DS also features stereo speakers providing virtual surround sound (depending on the software) located on either side of the upper display screen. This is a first for a Nintendo handheld, as the Game Boy line of systems has only supported stereo sound through the use of headphones or external speakers.



The name of the system, 'DS', is claimed to derive from the Dual Screen approach, with the bottom one supporting touch input